



Ethics Commission Meeting June 11th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9PSuEPC7KzY
Publication Date	2025-06-12T10:35:05Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Muny Ethics Commission

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer Jim Low called the June 11 meeting of the Muny Ethics Commission to order at [00:00:28](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chip Taylor, Susan Dylan, Sandra Whitaker, and Jim Low (Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not present in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the previous meeting were presented in the packet. A motion to approve the minutes as written was made and seconded, and the minutes were Approved by Voice Vote ([00:00:44](#) <U+2013> [00:01:07](#)).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:01:13](#) Discussion of Draft Electronic Meetings Policy

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chair Jim Low and City Attorney Allan Wisley.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission reviewed a draft electronic meetings policy modeled largely on the city council's existing code to comply with state law (IC 5-14). Commission members discussed restrictions regarding public hearings specifically noting that commissioners should not participate electronically when holding public hearings on complaints to ensure they can properly hear witnesses. The logistics of remote attendance (such as phone setups, laptops, Zoom integration, and audio clarity) were also discussed.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled to old business for formal action and adoption at the next meeting (00:06:49 <U+2013> 00:06:55).
- **00:07:01 Discussion on Transparency Portal Implementation & Purchasing Records**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chair Jim Low, alongside acknowledgments of assistance from City Clerk Lyndon Lacy and HR Director Patty Goddard.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commission reviewed the status of items required for the online transparency portal:
 1. *Code of Ethics*: Already online.
 2. *Ethics Commission Members*: Already online.
 3. *Conflict of Interest Forms*: Addressed via a recent HR email campaign by Patty Goddard providing video training and standard conflict disclosures. Cumulative quarterly reporting is planned.
 4. *Advisory Opinions*: None issued yet, but ready for publishing if requested.
 5. *Public Documents Related to Complaints*: One-page decision documents will be posted.
 6. *Annual Reports*: To be posted at the end of the commission's first year.
 7. *Training Compliance Documentation*: Completed and maintained by HR.
 8. *Public Documents Related to Purchases (\$5,000+)*: Detailed review of purchasing documentation requirements across four main procurement methods (low-value price gathering, invitation to quote, competitive bidding, and requests for proposals). The commission discussed coordinating with department heads and contractors to ensure appropriate records (such as bid notices, quotes, selected vendor rationale, and contracts) are submitted electronically to the city clerk's office starting retroactively from the beginning of the year.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion; no formal vote taken. Chair Low will draft an explanatory memo to coordinate with departments and the clerk's office.
- **00:06:01 Administrative Discussion: Correspondence Letterhead & Envelopes**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Clerk Lyndon Lacy and Chair Jim Low.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed logistical concerns regarding official commission correspondence being sent out using city clerk envelopes, which caused minor confusion for a recipient. The clerk's office and commission will establish a consistent labeling or sticker method so future mailings clearly originate from the Ethics Commission rather than appearing as a municipal clerk pass-through.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Administrative consensus to coordinate on labeling solutions.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No open public comment or citizen forum period occurred during this meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The next regular meeting is scheduled for **July 9 at 6:00 PM (00:29:48)**.
 - Agenda items for the next meeting will include old business on the electronic meetings policy and updates on the transparency portal.
- **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and Approved by Voice Vote at approximately **00:30:20**.

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